

The 6:15

SUNDAY · SEPTEMBER 27, 2026

NO. 19

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT, COLLAPSED

This week Tue 9/29 Yankees host Red Sox, ALWC Gm 1 (Yankee Stadium); winner to ALDS at Tampa Bay Oct. 3. Wed 9/30 Aug. PCE (BEA), 8:30a ET — first read since the Sept. 16 hike. Thu 10/1 Nike FQ1'27 earnings after close (**consensus ~\$0.44 EPS, not independently verified**). Knicks preseason opens Oct. 5 at Philadelphia.

Standing FOMC next meets Oct. 27-28. Next funding deadline Dec. 11 (Oct. 1 shutdown averted by Sept. 2 stopgap). OPEC+ October JMMC date still unconfirmed.

Weekend format: calendar collapsed to two lines per masthead convention.

METRICS · FRI 9/25 CLOSE/SETTLE, ET

Oil / rates / FX Brent & WTI **divergent across trackers, not reconciled** — see note. 10Y 5.17%; 2Y 4.81%; 30Y 5.49%-5.50%, near 2007-high territory. DXY 101.03 (-0.25%), 2-mo. high.

Equities / other S&P 7,743.41 (+0.51%), Nasdaq 27,068.72 (+0.5%), Dow 51,828.62 (+0.93%); VIX 14.87 (-5.11%); gold \$4,280.19. Asia: Nikkei +1.30% to 66,364.20, Hang Seng -1.0% to 24,510.09 (China/Korea/Taiwan holiday-closed); Europe **not verified**. AAA gas \$4.4874/gal nat'l avg (9/26).

Divergence: Brent quotes retrieved this run ranged \$97.44 (-2.77%, one Fri close) to \$105-107 intraday same day; WTI split \$92.41 (-2.33%) vs. \$93.02 (+1.86%). No settle reconciled across sources — treat direction only. Markets closed until Sun. 6:00p ET Globex reopen.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Transits Day 210 of closure. PortWatch: 1 transit Sept. 20 vs. 85/day baseline (~1% of normal); data runs days behind real time.

War-risk ~\$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~40x pre-crisis (trade-press est.); cumulative payouts >\$2B this month — 2nd-

largest marine underwriting payout in a decade.

Dark tankers

39 of 295 screened went dark, trailing 24h (~13%) — **tracker says indistinguishable from ambient AIS dropout**; separately, US officials claim ~60 ships still transiting — uncorroborated.

Methodology: PortWatch counts (lagged, official), dark-tanker share (trade-press AIS analysis, self-caveated) and war-risk premia (insurance-market reporting) measure different things over different windows — never averaged or netted here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees

Lost 10-2 at Baltimore Fri 9/25; finished 89-65 **(unreconciled with our own 91-67 tally through Wed 9/23 — see Sports)**. Host Boston, ALWC Gm 1, Tue 9/29.

Knicks

No reported moves in the last 24 hours; 5-game preseason (Oct. 5-15) NBA-confirmed.

Northwestern

Lost at No. 5 Indiana 29-23 Fri 9/25, falls to 2-1; no roster/staff moves reported.

LEAD

STRAIT OF HORMUZ

Trump rejects Iran's seven-day Hormuz roadmap; WSJ reports he's told aides to expect renewed strikes after the midterms

Iran's latest offer, delivered through Qatari mediators over the weekend, was specific: reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days and resume nuclear talks, in exchange for the US ending its naval blockade of Iranian ports, waiving sanctions on Iranian oil exports, halting what Tehran calls "acts of aggression" and economic warfare, and releasing frozen Iranian assets. Trump rejected it Saturday, telling reporters plainly: "They made a proposal, but I rejected it." He characterized the offer as Iran trying to reopen the strait "immediately because they're losing so badly" — reframing

what Tehran cast as a reciprocal de-escalation as a unilateral capitulation demand.

The more consequential piece is sourced to a single outlet: the Wall Street Journal, citing US officials, reports Trump has told aides he expects to resume bombing Iran after the November midterm elections, skeptical Iran could honor its end of any deal. **Single-sourced, flagged.** Officials quoted describe him as reluctant to resume major combat operations in the near term, with the scope of any renewed strikes still unclear and his position possibly contingent on the midterm results themselves — a genuine hedge, not a firm plan. That framing sits alongside Trump's own on-record remark at the UN General Assembly earlier in the week that he faces a "big decision" over whether to "annihilate" the Islamic Republic if negotiations fail — rhetoric that predates this specific rejection but points the same direction.

Iran's side of the channel is not fully aligned with Trump's public statement. Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Saturday that Tehran has seen "the first reaction from the US president" in news reports but that "nothing has been conveyed to us from the mediators yet" — meaning the formal, mediated rejection Iran would need to treat as authoritative has not arrived through the Qatari channel as of this morning, even though Trump has already said so publicly. Oman, the other standing mediator, used the moment to reaffirm its offer to keep facilitating talks and its commitment to protecting Hormuz navigation specifically — a signal the diplomatic track isn't formally closed, whatever Trump's public posture.

The mechanism worth sitting with: this doesn't reopen a closed door so much as it removes the near-term deadline pressure that talks were creating. With bombing now explicitly pushed to "after the

midterms" — a political calendar, not a negotiating one — the war's economic drag (a strait at ~1% of normal transit volume, war-risk premia near 40x peacetime, insurance payouts past \$2B, retail gas at a record for this calendar date) is priced to persist at least five to six weeks with no diplomatic catalyst in sight, and a rising probability of active US strikes on the other side of it. That is a different risk shape than "diplomacy grinding on toward an unclear outcome" — it is diplomacy explicitly shelved pending a domestic political event, which markets have less practice pricing than a slow-moving negotiation. Nothing in this morning's Hormuz counters — transit counts, dark-tanker share, premia — shows any change yet consistent with either de-escalation or fresh escalation; the rejection is a words-only event for now.

POLITICS

The Trump-Xi state visit wrapped Friday with, by CNBC's and the Washington Post's framing, "pomp over substance": tea at the White House, a joint viewing of the Declaration of Independence and Constitution at the National Archives, and warm public language from both leaders, but no announced breakthroughs beyond the trade-truce extension to Jan. 10 already reported in issue No. 18. Xi said the US and China have "the responsibility to develop and manage AI for good" while keeping it under human control — the most substantive on-record line from either leader on AI specifically. Taiwan, Ukraine and the Iran war were all raised in discussions per multiple outlets, but none produced a deliverable from this meeting; rare-earth-export and technology-control disputes remain unresolved. Trump said afterward the two would be "speaking a lot" and that "our farmers are going to be very happy" — vague enough that it reads as atmospherics rather than a specific commitment.

A second, separate front flared overnight: the Saudi-led coalition said early Saturday it intercepted two ballistic missiles aimed at Khamis Mushait and two drones aimed at Riyadh, launched by the Houthis. The Houthis have run a declared naval blockade against Saudi Arabia since July and have been striking Saudi-linked shipping in the Red Sea; this is a distinct conflict track from the US-Iran war and the Strait of Hormuz closure, though both raise the same regional war-risk backdrop feeding into the insurance premia in this issue's Board. No direct operational link between the Houthi attacks and the Iran nuclear-talks track was reported this run, and none should be assumed.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the rejection covered in the Lead, two data points temper any read of this weekend as pure escalation. First, the mediated channel is genuinely lagging the public statements: Araghchi's comment that Tehran has received nothing formal from mediators, set against Trump's on-record rejection, means the two sides are for the moment talking past each other through different channels at different speeds — a communications gap, not necessarily a closed door. Second, this issue's own Hormuz counters (Board) show no fresh data consistent with either side's framing: the dark-tanker share nominally fell to ~13% of screened vessels, but the tracker itself says that number can't currently be distinguished from ordinary AIS dropout, and a separate US claim of ~60 ships still transiting despite Iran's closure declaration is not corroborated by the PortWatch/straits.live counts. Oman's renewed mediation offer is the one concrete diplomatic fact this run that argues against treating Saturday's rejection as final.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost 10-2 at Baltimore Fri 9/25; finished 89-65 (unreconciled with prior 91-67 tally) . Host Boston, ALWC Gm 1, Tue 9/29 at Yankee Stadium; winner to ALDS at Tampa Bay Oct. 3.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours. 5-game preseason opens Oct. 5 at Philadelphia; defending NBA champions.
Northwestern	Lost at No. 5 Indiana 29-23 Fri 9/25 (Beebe 203 rush yds; Hoover 1-yd TD w/ 1:56 left sealed it); falls to 2-1. Next date not independently verified this run.

Continuity. Not refreshed this run: European market closes, OPEC+'s exact October JMMC date, the CNN/Politico/MS NOW White House access restriction (unresolved since Sept. 20), and

Ukraine/Sumy developments (not re-searched since issue No. 17). Economics and Business sections cut per weekend format — nothing broke in either this run. Watch for next issue: whether Qatari mediators formally convey Trump's rejection to Tehran; the Aug. PCE print (Sept. 30) and its effect on Oct. 27-28 hike odds; the Yankees-Red Sox ALWC Series (Gm 1 Tue 9/29) and reconciliation of the 89-65 vs. 91-67 record discrepancy; and whether Friday's Brent/WTI divergence resolves to a clean settle.

Unverified figures are marked in red: Brent/WTI settles, the exact 30Y print, European closes, Nike's earnings consensus, the Yankees' final record, Northwestern's next game, and the WSJ's single-sourced post-midterm-strikes framing. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.